

Doctoral School of Languages and Literatures
Adam Mickiewicz University in Poznań

Photography



Full name	Joanna Rękas
Academic title and position	Dr hab. Prof. of AMU
Faculty, Institute, Department/Research Unit	Faculty of Polish and Classical Philology, Institute of Slavic Philology, Gender and Transcultural Balkan Studies Unit, Oral Stories and Creative Practices Research Group
Scientific discipline	Main: Literary Studies Additional: Culture and Religion Studies, Health Sciences, Theological Sciences
Research areas	- folklore on the move and mobile sites of memory - oral narratives (oral stories) and mnemonic practices - cultural memory and affect studies - cultural anthropology and visual anthropology - biography, autoethnography and narratives of experience - ethnographic film and audiovisual practices - engaged and relational humanities - creative practices and art therapy in the humanities - cross-cultural experience, migration and neurodiversity - Balkan culture and folklore - traditional craftsmanship and intangible heritage - Orthodox theology and anthropology of religion

Description of scientific activity	My scientific research focuses on the study of folklore, cultural memory, and oral narratives in the context of mobility, migration, and transcultural contacts. I am developing the concept of "folklore on the move", conceptualising folklore as a dynamic, relational, and situational narrative practice that transcends traditional text-centric models. I combine perspectives from literary studies, cultural anthropology, cultural and religious studies, and health sciences, integrating fieldwork with creative practices, visual anthropology, and art therapy interventions. I treat ethnographic film, drawing, performative actions, and creative practices as equivalent cognitive and methodological tools in the humanities. Since 2025, I have been co-founding the interdisciplinary Spoken Narrative and Creative Practices Research Group, developing a model of engaged and relational humanities. My experience encompasses both monumental editions of ethnographic sources, including the materials of Józef Obrębski, and long-term fieldwork conducted in the Balkans, Central Europe, and Central America (Costa Rica). A significant aspect of my work remains the integration of scientific reflection with social practice. I collaborate with marginalised and neurodivergent communities, implementing projects in the fields of inclusive humanities, memory practices, and creative activities, including collaborations with the Płock Remand Centre, the K. Jonscher Clinic of Psychiatry in Poznań, and the Karol Marcinkowski University of Medical Sciences in Poznań. My research area also encompasses the issue of neurodiversity (ASD and ADHD), analysed from the perspective of engaged humanities, transcultural experience, and inclusive practices. As a neurodivergent individual, I incorporate an autoethnographic perspective into my research on communication, memory, creativity, and relationality. My interests also encompass the issues of religion and spirituality from an anthropological and cultural perspective, developed, inter alia, through my completed studies in Orthodox theology. I also developed organisational and strategic competencies as part of an MBA programme for higher education. I am currently completing postgraduate studies in art therapy at the Poznań University of Medical Sciences, preparing a dissertation focused on creative practices and their applications in the humanities and supportive interventions. Visual practices remain an integral part of my scientific and artistic activities. I am engaged in book illustration, including for children, developing visuality as an essential element of the humanities. In my research, I employ not only audiovisual recording and ethnographic film, but also drawing as a tool for documenting, interpreting, and activating memory, narrative, and relational processes within visual anthropology and art therapy practices.
Email address	joanna.rekas@amu.edu.pl
Websites, scholarly profiles (e.g. ResearchGate, ORCID, Google Scholar, etc.)	https://www.researchgate.net/profile/Joanna-Rekas-2
Activities aimed at improving supervisory competencies (e.g. training, workshops, etc.)	- conducting doctoral tutorials (since 2018) and Master's and diploma seminars (since 2007), with a particular emphasis on project work and fieldwork - substantive supervision of innovative student projects, including research on mnemonic graffiti conducted within the IDUB

	programme, University of the Future II, NCN and NCBiR grants, and others - conducting international and interdisciplinary teaching courses for students from various faculties and universities within the EPICUR, AMU PIE, Erasmus+, CEBS, and CEEPUS/CEI programmes, aimed at developing intercultural, project management, and research competencies - delivery of classes and workshops in multilingual and transcultural environments, involving collaboration with students representing various scientific disciplines and cultural backgrounds - developing relational, communication, and support competencies through postgraduate studies in art therapy (2025–2026) and an internship in a psychiatric ward (2025) - participation in international intensive programmes (including CREOLE) dedicated to sensory ethnography, affect studies, and contemporary anthropological theory - implementation of teaching internships and workshops as part of the University of Tomorrow II and NAWA - EPICUR programmes, covering issues of interculturality, communication, and the social competencies of researchers - developing methods for working with neurodivergent and marginalised environments within the framework of engaged and inclusive humanities activities - co-creating international research networks and organising scientific cooperation with visiting professors and foreign partners (including KRATFEST, Memory without Borders – MIGSTORIES) - developing organisational and strategic competencies within the framework of MBA studies for higher education.
--	--